CAS 760 — Development 2 Project: A Simple File System in Alonzo

Suleyman Kiani Hamza Jamil

April 16, 2026

Contents

1 Introduction **2**

2 Permissions **3**

3 Files **4**

4 Secured Files **5**

5 Directories **6**

6 Directory Development **8**

7 Theory Morphism: Files to Directories **9**

8 Examples **10**

9 Conclusion **10**

A Proofs and Validations for DIR-DEV **11**

A.1 Validation of Def 1 (contains) . . . 11
A.2 Thm 1: TOTAL2(contains) . . . 11
A.3 Thm 2: $\forall\, n : N$. contains n emptydir $= F_o$ . . . 11
A.4 Validation of Def 2 (size) . . . 11
A.5 Thm 3: TOTAL(size) . . . 12
A.6 Thm 4: size emptydir $= 0$ . . . 12
A.7 Thm 5: $\forall\, f : F,\, d : D$. size (addfile f d) $=$ size $d + 1$ . . . 12
A.8 Thm 6: $\forall\, d : D$. size $d \geq 0$ . . . 12

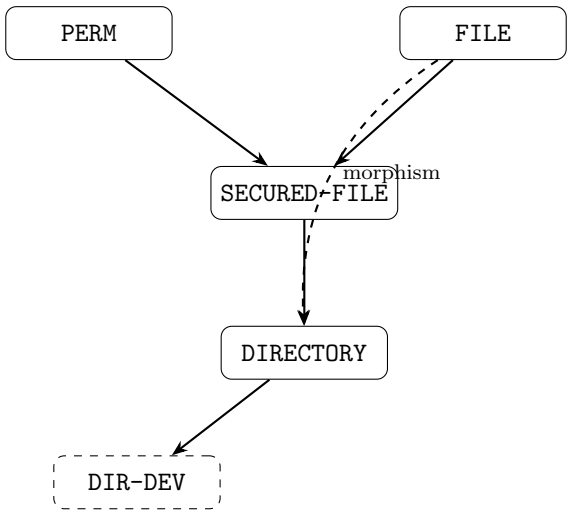
1 Introduction

This paper formalizes a simple file system as a development graph in Alonzo, following the little theories method [1]. File systems are a fundamental concept in computing: they organize data into named, content-bearing objects (files), assign permissions to control access, and group files into hierarchical directories. Each of these concepts corresponds naturally to a theory in the little theories framework.

We build a hierarchy of increasingly complex structures. The base theories PERM and FILE capture permissions and basic files independently. The theory extension SECURED-FILE combines both, associating a permission level with each file. A further extension DIRECTORY introduces directories as inductive structures over secured files. Key operations (lookup, containment, directory size) are developed in DIR-DEV, and a theory morphism shows that single files embed into the directory structure.

The development follows the module format established in the textbook and the monoids paper of Farmer & Zvigelsky [2]. We use compact notation throughout, dropping type subscripts where unambiguous, consistent with Notational Convention 5 of [1].

Theory graph.



Solid boxes are theories (theory definitions or extensions). The dashed box is a development definition. Solid arrows denote theory extensions. The dashed arrow denotes the theory morphism FILE-to-DIR.

Work division.

- **Suleyman Kiani**: FILE, SECURED-FILE, DIRECTORY, DIR-DEV (Sections 3–6), including all proofs and validations.
- **Hamza Jamil**: PERM, theory morphism FILE-to-DIR (Sections 2 and 7), examples, and presentation lead.

2 Permissions

A file system associates *permissions* with files to control access. We model a simple permission hierarchy with four levels: no access, read-only, read-write, and administrator. These form an enumeration inductive type — a finite set freely generated by four nullary constructors, analogous to the theory of Boolean values (BOOLE) in Chapter 10 of [1].

Theory Definition 2.1 (Permissions)**.**

Name: PERM.

Base types: P.

Constants: $\mathsf{noaccess}_P$, rd_P, wr_P, admin_P.

Axioms:

1. $\mathsf{DISTINCT}(\mathsf{noaccess}, \mathsf{rd}, \mathsf{wr}, \mathsf{admin})$ (all constructors are distinct).
2. $\forall\, p : \{P\} \,.\, p\ \mathsf{noaccess} \ \wedge\ p\ \mathsf{rd} \ \wedge\ p\ \mathsf{wr} \ \wedge\ p\ \mathsf{admin} \Rightarrow \forall\, x : P \,.\, p\ x$ (structural induction).

Explanation. Axiom 1 states that the four permission values are pairwise distinct (using the DISTINCT abbreviation from Table 6.2 of [1]). Axiom 2 is the structural induction principle: any predicate that holds for all four constructors holds for every element of P. Together, these axioms make (P, C) an enumeration inductive type where $C = \{\mathsf{noaccess}, \mathsf{rd}, \mathsf{wr}, \mathsf{admin}\}$, so in every standard model, P has exactly four elements.

3 Files

A *file* is a named container for content. In a real file system, a file has (at minimum) a name and content. We model this as a theory with a constructor mkfile that builds a file from a name and content, and accessor functions fname and fcontent that extract the components.

This theory defines the space of all possible files over arbitrary name and content types. It is analogous to a simple record type `type file = {name : N; content : C}` in OCaml.

Theory Definition 3.1 (Files)**.**

Name: FILE.

Base types: N, C, F.

Constants: $\mathsf{mkfile}_{N \to C \to F}$, $\mathsf{fname}_{F \to N}$, $\mathsf{fcontent}_{F \to C}$.

Axioms:

1. $\mathsf{TOTAL2}(\mathsf{mkfile})$ (mkfile is total).
2. $\mathsf{INJ2}(\mathsf{mkfile})$ (mkfile is injective).
3. $\forall\, n : N,\, c : C \,.\, \mathsf{fname}\ (\mathsf{mkfile}\ n\ c) = n$ (name accessor).
4. $\forall\, n : N,\, c : C \,.\, \mathsf{fcontent}\ (\mathsf{mkfile}\ n\ c) = c$ (content accessor).
5. $\mathsf{TOTAL}(\mathsf{fname})$ (fname is total).
6. $\mathsf{TOTAL}(\mathsf{fcontent})$ (fcontent is total).
7. $\forall\, f : F \,.\, \mathsf{mkfile}\ (\mathsf{fname}\ f)\ (\mathsf{fcontent}\ f) = f$ (surjectivity of mkfile).

Explanation of the axioms. Axiom 1 states that any name–content pair produces a valid file. Axiom 2 ensures distinct pairs produce distinct files ("no confusion"). Axioms 3–4 define the accessor functions via their interaction with the constructor. Axioms 5–6 ensure the accessors are total on all files. Axiom 7 establishes that every file is constructible — i.e., mkfile is surjective, so the type F is exactly the set of name–content pairs. Together, Axioms 1–2 and 7 make F isomorphic to $N \times C$.

Design note. We could alternatively model files using the product type $N \times C$ with the built-in projection functions fst and snd. We choose an abstract type F with explicit accessors to allow extension with additional attributes (e.g., permissions) via theory extensions, which is more natural in the little theories setting.

4 Secured Files

A *secured file* is a file that has been assigned a permission level. We model this as a theory extension of FILE that adds a permission-assignment function. The permission type P (with its ordering structure) is defined in PERM; here we use P as a base type whose properties will be inherited when SECURED-FILE is connected to PERM in the full development graph.

Theory Extension 4.1 (Secured Files)**.**

Name: SECURED-FILE.

Extends FILE.

New base types: P.

New constants: $\mathsf{perm}_{F \to P}$, $\mathsf{protect}_{F \to P \to F}$.

New axioms:

8. $\mathsf{TOTAL}(\mathsf{perm})$ (perm is total).
9. $\mathsf{TOTAL2}(\mathsf{protect})$ (protect is total).
10. $\forall\, f : F,\, p : P \,.\, \mathsf{perm}\ (\mathsf{protect}\ f\ p) = p$ (protect sets permission).
11. $\forall\, f : F,\, p : P \,.\, \mathsf{fname}\ (\mathsf{protect}\ f\ p) = \mathsf{fname}\ f$ (protect preserves name).
12. $\forall\, f : F,\, p : P \,.\, \mathsf{fcontent}\ (\mathsf{protect}\ f\ p) = \mathsf{fcontent}\ f$ (protect preserves content).

Explanation of the axioms. Axiom 8 states that every file has an assigned permission. Axiom 9 ensures that applying a permission always succeeds. Axiom 10 defines the core semantics of protect: after applying protect f p, the permission of the resulting file is p. Axioms 11–12 guarantee that protect only changes the permission — it does not alter the file's name or content.

SECURED-FILE extends FILE by adding one new base type P (permission levels), and two new constants. The axiom numbering continues from FILE (Axioms 1–7), consistent with the convention for theory extensions (Section 9.2 of [1]). The language of SECURED-FILE is the language of FILE augmented with the new type P and constants perm, protect.

5 Directories

A *directory* is a collection of secured files organized as a flat structure. We model this as an inductive type: a directory is either empty or formed by adding a secured file to an existing directory. This mirrors the standard inductive structure of lists (cf. the parallel between PA and lists in Theory Definition 9.7 of [1]).

We add two new constructors: emptydir (the empty directory, analogous to nil in lists) and addfile (add a file to a directory, analogous to cons).

Theory Extension 5.1 (Directories).

Name: DIRECTORY.

Extends SECURED-FILE.

New base types: D.

New constants: $\mathsf{emptydir}_D$, $\mathsf{addfile}_{F\to D\to D}$.

New axioms:

13. $\mathsf{TOTAL2}(\mathsf{addfile})$ (addfile is total).
14. $\mathsf{INJ2}(\mathsf{addfile})$ (addfile is injective).
15. $\forall f : F,\, d : D \,.\, \mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d \neq \mathsf{emptydir}$ (disjointness).
16. $\forall p : \{D\} \,.\, p\ \mathsf{emptydir} \ \wedge\ \forall f : F,\, d : D \,.\, p\ d \Rightarrow p\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) \Rightarrow \forall d : D \,.\, p\ d$ (structural induction).

Inductive type verification. The constructors for D are $C = \{\mathsf{emptydir}_D,\ (\mathsf{addfile}_{F\to D\to D},\ U_{\{F\}})\}$. Here emptydir is a nullary constructor (first kind) and $(\mathsf{addfile}, U_{\{F\}})$ is a fourth-kind constructor: its type is $F \to D \to D$ (in Curryed form), the quasitype $U_{\{F\}}$ indicates the first argument ranges over all of F, and the presence of D in the domain makes addfile recursive.

Checking the obligations (Chapter 10, Section 10.2 of [1]):

(a) $U_{\{F\}} \neq \emptyset_{\{F\}}$: holds since F is a base type and every base type domain is nonempty (frame condition F2, Definition 5.1 of [1]).

(b) $\mathsf{addfile}{\downarrow}$ as a total function: $\mathsf{TOTAL2}(\mathsf{addfile})$ (Axiom 13).

(c) TOTAL-ON for addfile: follows from Axiom 13.

(d) $\mathsf{INJ2}(\mathsf{addfile})$: Axiom 14. This ensures distinct file–directory pairs produce distinct directories.

(e) $\mathsf{emptydir} \notin \mathsf{ran}(\mathsf{addfile})$: follows from Axiom 15 (disjointness).

(f) Disjoint ranges: trivially satisfied (only one nonnullary constructor).

(g) Structural induction: Axiom 16.

Hence (D, C) is a recursive inductive type in DIRECTORY. By the Inductive Types Theorem (Chapter 10 of [1]), in every standard model M of DIRECTORY, D_D^M consists of exactly $I^M(\mathsf{emptydir})$ and all values of the form $I^M(\mathsf{addfile})(d_f, \sigma)$ for $d_f \in D_F^M$ and $\sigma \in D_D^M$. That is, D_D^M is isomorphic to the set of finite multisets (or sequences, given injectivity) over D_F^M.

Comparison with LIST-TYPE. The following table shows the structural parallel between DIRECTORY and a list type:

LIST	**DIRECTORY**	**Role**
L	D	inductive type
E (element)	F (file)	element type
nil_L	$\mathsf{emptydir}_D$	nullary constructor
$\mathsf{cons}_{E \to L \to L}$	$\mathsf{addfile}_{F \to D \to D}$	recursive constructor
TOTAL2(cons)	TOTAL2($\mathsf{addfile}$)	totality
$\mathsf{cons}\ e\ l \neq \mathsf{nil}$	$\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d \neq \mathsf{emptydir}$	disjointness
INJ2(cons)	INJ2($\mathsf{addfile}$)	injectivity

6 Directory Development

We now define derived operations on directories and prove key properties. Following the lesson from Development Project 1 (see Section 9), all operations are *defined* in this development using definite descriptions, not introduced as theory extension constants.

Development Definition 6.1 (Directory Development).

Name: DIR-DEV.

Bottom theory: DIRECTORY.

Definitions and theorems:

Def 1 (contains). $\mathsf{contains}_{N \to D \to o} = \mathrm{I}\, g : N \to D \to o \,.\, \forall\, n : N \,.\, g\; n\; \mathsf{emptydir} = F_o \;\wedge\; \forall\, n : N,\, f : F,\, d : D \,.\, g\; n\; (\mathsf{addfile}\; f\; d) = (\mathsf{fname}\; f = n) \vee g\; n\; d$

Remark. The predicate $\mathsf{contains}\; n\; d$ tests whether a file with name n exists in directory d. It is defined by structural recursion on d: the empty directory contains nothing, and $\mathsf{addfile}\; f\; d$ contains name n if either f has name n or d already contains n.

Thm 1. $\mathsf{TOTAL2}(\mathsf{contains})$ (contains is total).

Thm 2. $\forall\, n : N \,.\, \mathsf{contains}\; n\; \mathsf{emptydir} = F_o$ (empty directory contains nothing).

Def 2 (size). $\mathsf{size}_{D \to \mathbb{N}} = \mathrm{I}\, g : D \to \mathbb{N} \,.\, g\; \mathsf{emptydir} = 0 \;\wedge\; \forall\, f : F,\, d : D \,.\, g\; (\mathsf{addfile}\; f\; d) = g\; d + 1$

Remark. The function $\mathsf{size}\; d$ returns the number of file entries in directory d.

Thm 3. $\mathsf{TOTAL}(\mathsf{size})$ (size is total).

Thm 4. $\mathsf{size}\; \mathsf{emptydir} = 0$ (empty directory has size zero).

Thm 5. $\forall\, f : F,\, d : D \,.\, \mathsf{size}\; (\mathsf{addfile}\; f\; d) = \mathsf{size}\; d + 1$ (addfile increments size).

Thm 6. $\forall\, d : D \,.\, \mathsf{size}\; d \geq 0$ (size is non-negative).

Definitions are validated and theorems are proved in Appendix A. Note that contains and size are defined using definite descriptions (I-terms): each definition asserts the existence of a unique function satisfying the given recursion equations. The validations prove that these definite descriptions are defined (i.e., the I-terms denote values).

7 Theory Morphism: Files to Directories

We exhibit a theory morphism from FILE to DIRECTORY to demonstrate that individual files embed into the directory structure. Intuitively, a single file f corresponds to the one-element directory addfile f emptydir.

Theory Translation Definition 7.1 (Files to Directories)**.**

Name: FILE-to-DIR.

Source theory: FILE.

Target theory: DIRECTORY.

Base type mapping:

$N \mapsto N$ (names are preserved)

$C \mapsto C$ (contents are preserved)

$F \mapsto D$

Constant mapping:

$\mathsf{mkfile}_{N \to C \to F} \mapsto \lambda\, n : N \,.\, \lambda\, c : C \,.\, \mathsf{addfile}\ (\mathsf{mkfile}\ n\ c)\ \mathsf{emptydir}$

$\mathsf{fname}_{F \to N} \mapsto \lambda\, d : D \,.\, \mathsf{fname}\ (\mathsf{hd}\ d)$ (where hd extracts the first file)

$\mathsf{fcontent}_{F \to C} \mapsto \lambda\, d : D \,.\, \mathsf{fcontent}\ (\mathsf{hd}\ d)$

Verification. We must show that the image of each FILE axiom under this morphism is valid in DIRECTORY. The key insight is that on single-entry directories (those of the form addfile f emptydir), the translated operations behave identically to the original file operations.

1. **TOTAL2(mkfile) maps to totality of the translation**: Since TOTAL2(addfile) (Axiom 13 of DIRECTORY) and TOTAL2(mkfile) (Axiom 1 of FILE), the composed function $\lambda\, n : N \,.\, \lambda\, c : C \,.\, \mathsf{addfile}\ (\mathsf{mkfile}\ n\ c)\ \mathsf{emptydir}$ is total.

2. **INJ2(mkfile) maps to injectivity of the translation**: If addfile (mkfile n_1 c_1) emptydir = addfile (mkfile n_2 c_2) emptydir, then mkfile n_1 c_1 = mkfile n_2 c_2 by INJ2(addfile) (Axiom 14), and then $n_1 = n_2$ and $c_1 = c_2$ by INJ2(mkfile) (Axiom 2).

3. **Accessor axioms (Axioms 3–4) map correctly**: The translated accessors extract the name and content of the single file in the directory, which equals the original name and content by the accessor axioms of FILE.

4. **Surjectivity (Axiom 7) maps to a restricted surjectivity**: Every single-entry directory is constructible from a name and content via the translated constructor.

By the Morphism Theorem (Theorem 14.16 of [1]), all theorems of FILE transport to DIRECTORY under this morphism. This confirms that single files embed faithfully into the directory structure.

8 Examples

9 Conclusion

A Proofs and Validations for DIR-DEV

A.1 Validation of Def 1 (contains)

We must show that the definite description $\mathrm{I}\, g : N \to D \to o \,.\, \ldots$ denotes a value, i.e., there exists a unique function $g : N \to D \to o$ satisfying:

$$\forall\, n : N \,.\, g\ n\ \mathsf{emptydir} = F_o \tag{R1}$$

$$\forall\, n : N,\ f : F,\ d : D \,.\, g\ n\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = (\mathsf{fname}\ f = n) \vee g\ n\ d \tag{R2}$$

Existence. Define g by: for fixed $n : N$, define $g\ n$ by structural recursion on the second argument $d : D$. By the structural induction principle (Axiom 16 of DIRECTORY), every $d : D$ is either emptydir or addfile $f\ d'$ for unique $f : F$ and $d' : D$. Define:

$$g\ n\ d\ =\ \begin{cases} F_o & \text{if } d = \mathsf{emptydir}, \\ (\mathsf{fname}\ f = n) \vee g\ n\ d' & \text{if } d = \mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d'. \end{cases}$$

This is well-defined by structural recursion (each recursive call is on a structurally smaller second argument). The expression $(\mathsf{fname}\ f = n) \vee g\ n\ d'$ is defined since fname is total (Axiom 5 of FILE), equality is always defined, and $\vee$ is total. Hence g satisfies (R1) and (R2).

Uniqueness. If g and h both satisfy (R1) and (R2), then for any fixed $n : N$, by structural induction on d:

- **Base:** $g\ n\ \mathsf{emptydir} = F_o = h\ n\ \mathsf{emptydir}$.
- **Step:** If $g\ n\ d = h\ n\ d$, then $g\ n\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = (\mathsf{fname}\ f = n) \vee g\ n\ d = (\mathsf{fname}\ f = n) \vee h\ n\ d = h\ n\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d)$.

Hence $g = h$. □

A.2 Thm 1: TOTAL2(contains)

Proof. We show $\mathsf{contains}\ n\ d{\downarrow}$ for all $n : N$, $d : D$ by structural induction on d.

Base case: $\mathsf{contains}\ n\ \mathsf{emptydir} = F_o{\downarrow}$.

Inductive step: Assume $\mathsf{contains}\ n\ d{\downarrow}$. Then $\mathsf{contains}\ n\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = (\mathsf{fname}\ f = n) \vee \mathsf{contains}\ n\ d$. Since $\mathsf{fname}\ f{\downarrow}$ (Axiom 5), equality is defined, $\mathsf{contains}\ n\ d{\downarrow}$ (IH), and $\vee$ is total, the result is defined.

By structural induction (Axiom 16), TOTAL2(contains). □

A.3 Thm 2: $\forall\, n : N \,.\, \mathsf{contains}\ n\ \mathsf{emptydir} = F_o$

Immediate from the definition of contains (equation R1). □

A.4 Validation of Def 2 (size)

We must show that $\mathrm{I}\, g : D \to \mathbb{N} \,.\, \ldots$ denotes a value.

Existence. Define g by structural recursion on d: $g\ \mathsf{emptydir} = 0$ and $g\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = g\ d + 1$. This is well-defined since the recursive call is on the structurally smaller argument d, and $+1$ is total on $\mathbb{N}$.

Uniqueness. By structural induction: if g and h both satisfy the recursion, then $g\ \mathsf{emptydir} = 0 = h\ \mathsf{emptydir}$, and if $g\ d = h\ d$ then $g\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = g\ d + 1 = h\ d + 1 = h\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d)$. Hence $g = h$. □

A.5 Thm 3: $\mathsf{TOTAL}(\mathsf{size})$

Proof. By structural induction on d.

Base: $\mathsf{size}\ \mathsf{emptydir} = 0{\downarrow}$.

Step: Assume $\mathsf{size}\ d{\downarrow}$. Then $\mathsf{size}\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = \mathsf{size}\ d + 1$. Since $\mathsf{size}\ d{\downarrow}$ (IH) and $+1$ is total on $\mathbb{N}$, the result is defined. □

A.6 Thm 4: $\mathsf{size}\ \mathsf{emptydir} = 0$

Immediate from the definition of size. □

A.7 Thm 5: $\forall\, f : F,\, d : D\ .\ \mathsf{size}\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = \mathsf{size}\ d + 1$

Immediate from the definition of size. □

A.8 Thm 6: $\forall\, d : D\ .\ \mathsf{size}\ d \geq 0$

Proof. By structural induction on d.

Base: $\mathsf{size}\ \mathsf{emptydir} = 0 \geq 0$.

Step: Assume $\mathsf{size}\ d \geq 0$. Then $\mathsf{size}\ (\mathsf{addfile}\ f\ d) = \mathsf{size}\ d + 1 \geq 0 + 1 = 1 \geq 0$. □

References

[1] W. M. Farmer, *Simple Type Theory: A Practical Logic for Expressing and Reasoning About Mathematical Ideas*, 2nd ed., Birkhäuser, 2025.

[2] W. M. Farmer and D. Y. Zvigelsky, "Monoid Theory in Alonzo: A Little Theories Formalization in Simple Type Theory," *Journal of Applied Logics*, vol. 12, no. 7, 2025.